he couldn’t see a way forward with the ideas from his own theory. “Because I did not see clearly, at the time, how to proceed further,” he said years later, “my interests began to turn in other directions.” This change came at roughly the same time as another, related, major intellectual shift for Bohm: in the wake of the brutal suppression of the Hungarian Uprising in 1956, Bohm abandoned his Marxism. This change in philosophy altered Bohm’s thinking about the nature of the quantum world, which further motivated him to abandon his old ideas.

As Bohm searched for a new approach to quantum physics, he finally found some stability in his professional life. He left Israel in 1957, taking a temporary appointment at the University of Bristol in the UK. Several years later, he found a permanent position at Birkbeck College at the University of London. And eventually, he was offered two permanent positions in the United States: one at the newly formed Brandeis University in Boston, and another several years later at the New Mexico Institute of Mining and Technology. But when he attempted to take these jobs, he faced a new problem: the US government, upon learning of his Brazilian citizenship, had stripped him of his American citizenship. And with his ties to communism still fresh in the minds of State Department officials, Bohm’s application to regain his citizenship in his native land was not looked upon kindly. He could return and become an American again, they told him—if he publicly renounced communism. Although Bohm was no longer a Marxist of any stripe, he considered it unethical to publicly renounce his former political views simply as a means to some other practical end. “I feel it wrong to say it [criticize communism] in order to regain American citizenship. For then, I am saying something not mainly because I think it is true, but rather, for some ulterior purpose. It’s rather like writing a scientific article in order to impress one’s superior, so as to get a better job.” Unwilling to compromise his integrity, Bohm remained at Birkbeck.

Meanwhile, the pilot-wave interpretation sank into obscurity as Bohm searched for a new way to understand the quantum world. But back at Princeton, where all his troubles began, a new alternative had already been found.